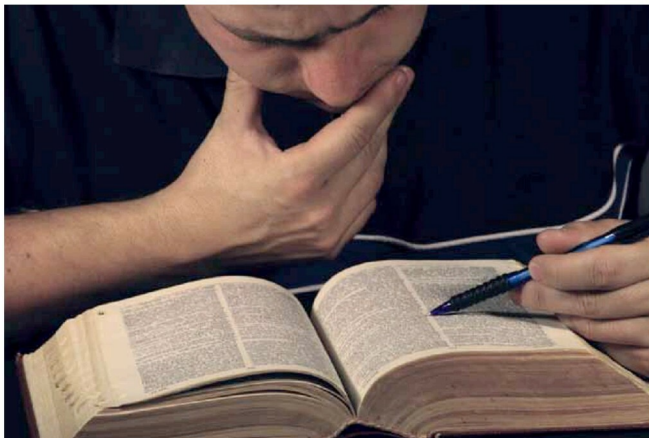


Localisation: The Status of Education and Training

This article surveys the education and training opportunities in language services available in India and across the world.



Common Sense Advisory is an independent market research company serving the worldwide translation, localisation, interpreting, globalisation and internationalisation marketplace. Its estimate for outsourced language services in 2011 was US\$ 29.885 billion. Europe (49.38 per cent) was the largest region, followed by North America (34.85 per cent) and Asia (12.88 per cent). There were around 26,104 language service providers (LSPs) with two or more employees. More than 95 per cent of LSPs have small-scale operations employing just a few people. The localisation market is projected to reach US\$ 33.523 billion by the end of 2012, which means an annual growth rate of 12.17 per cent. Unfortunately, there are very few details about the Indian market in the open domain, though it is estimated at about US\$ 0.5 billion in 2010, based on the IT enabled services market share.

People graduating with a diploma or degree in translation studies or linguistics courses join the LSPs. Some people who know more than one language work as freelancers. However, as localisation is a specialised area, there is a need for training on the theory and the tools. In the last decade, pre-conference tutorials as part of the annual Localisation World Conference, custom training from experienced professionals, and tool vendors offered the main training opportunities. A few universities and institutions have started offering offline and online courses and certifications in recent years. More details on such offerings are given below.

USA

In the USA, a Localisation Certification Program was launched in 2006 by California State University in partnership